Haunted

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/56811094.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Castaspella/Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Ghost Shadow Weaver, Implied/Referenced Child Abuse, Implied/Referenced Suicide, Ghosts, Fluff, i gues?, What Else Do I Tag?

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by Psychopath_seal

Summary

Casta moves into a new house and is constantly terrorized by a ghost who just wants to mess with her.

Castaspella opened the door of her new apartment and stepped inside. She scanned the room, it looked old, the paint on the walls was slowly falling off and there were huge spiderwebs everywhere, but it was still good for the price. People said this place was haunted by some ghosts, but how bad can it be? It's not like this ghost (if there even was one) has ever killed anyone. From what she heard it was just annoying. And she also loved the spooky aesthetic of this house. She always liked witchcraft, ghosts, demons, and stuff like that. It started as a form of rebellion against her religious parents, but after some time it just became something she enjoyed. When she first got a job offer in this town, she knew she couldn't refuse it and no ghost could change that.

The first few weeks were pretty normal, she cleaned the spiderwebs and finished moving her stuff. The town looked beautiful this time of year and Casta was starting to like it. Unfortunately, it didn't take long for weird stuff to start happening. In the beginning, it was things like doors slamming, lights flickering, and strange noises in the middle of the night. These were all things Casta could live with. After all, it was nothing you wouldn't expect from an old, haunted house. And it didn't bother her much since she worked a lot and wasn't home for most of the day.

But then, one night it all got worse. Casta was having a weird dream, all she could remember from it was seeing a woman in a red dress, and no matter how hard she looked, Casta could not see her face. Then she woke up. Once her eyes adjusted to the darkness she realized that no light was shining through the window, but somehow she could still see everything in the room. There were strange shadows on the wall that she could swear were moving and forming strange silhouettes. Casta noticed light coming from the hallway. She got up to check where it was coming from and saw that the light in the bathroom was on. Once she opened the door she froze at the sight of what looked like something from a horror movie. The sink was splattered with what looked like blood, it made her want to throw up. She looked

up and saw the words “you’re welcome” written in the mirror. Casta looked at her reflection and saw the same faceless woman in a red dress she saw in her dream standing behind her, she turned around and saw no one was there. She held back a scream. Her heartbeat was racing. Terrified of everything happening around her, she returned to her bed and hid under the covers like a child, hoping this night would end soon.

When Casta woke up, she immediately went to the bathroom and was relieved to see that the bloody writing on the mirror was gone. However, her relief didn’t last long. When she looked down she saw that the sink was still covered in blood.

After cleaning all the blood and eating breakfast while being startled by slamming doors and flickering lights she decided to go for a walk. After she walked for a while, thinking about all the weird stuff that happened, Casta sat down on a bench in the park and pulled out her phone. After what happened last night she thought it would be good to find out all she could about this ghost in case it ever tried to attack her. Casta decided it would be safer to search here than at home, she didn’t want to anger the ghost even more.

It took her a few searches, but she finally found some useful information. Many people who lived in the house saw the same things as Casta did: flickering lights, blood in the bathroom, and shadows that moved on their own. Because of those moving shadows that people saw the ghost was known as Shadow Weaver, it is said to be the spirit of a woman who lived in the house a long time ago. Casta also found out that this woman supposedly practiced witchcraft and was accused of murder. Many websites also mentioned her being a lesbian next to this as if it was some sort of horrible crime. Casta rolled her eyes at that and kept reading. She found out that Shadow Weaver killed herself, although people still argue about why she did it. Most people say she did it out of guilt for her actions while others say she did this as a way of manipulating people into feeling sorry for her, some even said it was some sort of deal with the devil.

Knowing all that information Casta still didn't know what to do with the ghost. She could always try to summon it and talk to it, but summoning a potential murderer might do more harm than good. She would just have to live with it and hope it gets better.

Unfortunately, it only got worse. Every single night the same thing would happen. She would wake in the middle of the night and would see shadows moving, and hear whispers and whenever she went to the bathroom, she would find blood in the sink and sometimes on the floor. And to make things worse, the ghost also terrorized her during the day. Casta would find things in places where they shouldn't be, stuff would fall off shelves for no reason, and she would lose her phone or keys at least four times a day. However, she couldn't blame ghosts for the last thing, her forgetfulness was responsible for that.

Eventually, she got tired of it and decided to finally talk to the ghost. She had to try to put an end to this madness. It was finally time to summon the ghost on the night of the full moon. Just in case the ghost tried to attack her, she sat in a circle of salt. She turned off the lights and held up an unlit candle. “Show yourself.” She whispered. The candle lit up and the same red-cloaked figure now stood before her. After a few moments of awkward silence, she finally gathered enough courage to speak.

“You’re Shadow Weaver, right?” Castaspella asked.``That’s what most people call me.” The ghost answered. “Why did you summon me?” She asked. “I wanted to ask you what do you want with me?” “Nothing, I’m just bored.” Shadow Weaver replied. “ Don’t you have anything better to do?” Casta questioned while trying to keep eye contact with the ghost, which was difficult to do since Shadow Weaver was taller than her and floating about 20 centimeters above the floor. Not to mention that staring into the ghost’s white glowing eyes was quite offputting. “No, I don’t.” Shadow Weaver finally said. “ Are you going to hurt me?” Casta asked. “No, I am not. And you should probably get some sleep if you don’t want to be late to work tomorrow.” Shadow Weaver said before blowing out the candle and leaving Castaspella in complete

darkness. Casta decided to listen to the ghost’s advice and went to bed. “This was completely pointless.” She thought to herself.

The next morning she woke up and went to the kitchen to make breakfast for herself. After eating she got up and headed towards the door only to realize she had forgotten her phone. She looked for it everywhere: in her room, under the bed, on the kitchen counter, in the living room, and even in places like under the sink and in the washing machine. But it was nowhere to be seen. Once she had completely given up, she heard a voice behind her. “Looking for something?” She turned around to see Shadow Weaver sitting on the couch and holding her phone. “How are you still here?” Casta hissed with anger in her voice. “Since you summoned me last night, I have been able to enter the physical realm and now I have so many new ways to mess with you. Oh, this will be fun.” The ghost exclaimed. Casta looked at her with annoyance, grabbed the phone from Shadow Weaver's cold hands, and hurried out the door. She didn't want to be late for work.

When she came back home tired that evening she wanted nothing more than a cup of tea and some sleep. She suspected that Shadow Weaver had probably made a mess somewhere in the apartment, but she was so exhausted she didn't even care, so whatever it was, it would have to wait until the morning.

The next few weeks Casta was so busy with work, that she started completely ignoring the ghost, which was harder to do now that Shadow Weaver could freely roam around the house and talk to her now. “ You will never finish this if you keep working at the speed of a snail.” Shadow Weaver teased her for the hundredth time. Casta said nothing and continued to work on her laptop. The ghost wasn’t the only thing she was ignoring, she couldn’t remember the last time she cleaned the house or did the dishes. Her apartment was a complete mess.

One day when she came back home from work she noticed that her home looked a lot cleaner than it did in the morning and there were no more dishes left in the sink. She turned around to see

Shadow Weaver behind her. “Did you clean the dishes?” She asked the ghost. “ I couldn’t keep living in this mess forever, so I cleaned up a bit. Although I didn’t touch your room, you will have to clean it yourself.” Said Shadow Weaver. “Thanks,” Casta replied. She could swear she saw Shadow blush.

After cleaning her messy room, Casta sat down on the couch, picked up a random book, and started reading. The book wasn't even that interesting and Casta was tired so she had to re-read some words a few times to understand what they meant. Eventually, she fell asleep, and the last thing she could feel before her mind drifted into deep sleep was cold, ghostly hands placing a soft blanket on her.

The weekend finally came and Casta had absolutely nothing to do. Since her apartment still looked as old, haunted, and depressing as the day she moved in, she decided to get some plants to brighten the place up a little. The store didn’t have many plants, but Casta didn’t care about that since she was sure that due to her lack of time and gardening skills, the plants would die quickly anyway. She picked daisies because out of all the flowers there they were the prettiest. When she came home, she placed the flower pot near the window and went to the kitchen to make some tea. Once she returned, she found Shadow standing there and looking at the flowers. “ What? Are you angry at me for ruining the spooky atmosphere with some flowers?” Asked Casta. “No, quite the opposite. Daisies are my favorite flowers actually, I find them cheerful.” The ghost replied. “That’s good to hear.”

That evening Casta was watching a horror movie, it didn’t seem so scary after everything that happened with Shadow Weaver. Speaking of her, the ghost was sitting on the couch next to Casta and seemed not to be paying any attention to anything happening around them. Eventually, Casta got bored of the movie and turned off the TV. “I’m going to bed.” She announced, unsure why she needed to inform Shadow Weaver of that. “Ok, goodnight, Cas.” The ghost replied. “ Goodnight, Shadow.” Casta went to her bedroom and realized that for once the feeling of Shadow

Weaver's ghostly presence nearby felt more comforting than threatening.

The following morning Casta found Shadow in the same spot as yesterday, looking at the daisies. “Good morning,” Casta said. “Good morning,” Shadow mumbled. Casta made herself a cup of coffee and returned to Shadow Weaver. ”You know, after everything that happened… Maybe we don’t have to fight each other. The thing I’m trying to say is that we could be like… friends. We seem to get along when we want to and we have a lot in common.” Casta said. Shadow froze, her face turned paler than before and her hands started trembling.“D… don’t… don’t say that,” Shadow whispered in a shaking voice. “Say what?” Casta asked, confused. “Don’t compare yourself to me.”

“Why?” Asked Casta, shocked by Shadow’s reaction. “I’m not a good person, Casta. I have hurt and killed people. I just couldn’t get enough of it, it was like an addiction. I made many people’s lives a living nightmare, including my own children’s. I hate myself for it. And this… this afterlife is my punishment for it. I didn’t want to live with the reality of my actions, so now they haunt me forever. so yes, we can be friends but don’t ever compare yourself to me again.” “Ok, I won’t,” Casta promised.

Months flew by, it was the middle of February now. Snow was falling outside the windows and as Casta spent more time in Shadow’s company, she started to like her even more. Soon, she realized that her feelings had evolved into something beyond friendship. Casta thought it would pass with time but it never did. At first, she felt so stupid, having a crush on a ghost, but eventually, she decided to just confess her feelings. “Hey, Shadow. There’s something I need to tell you.” Casta said. “What is it, Cas?” Shadow asked. “I… I don’t know how to properly say this but… I love you.” “Oh… oh, I kind of suspected that. You’re bad at hiding it. But you do realize that I’m dead, right?” “Yes, I do, but it doesn’t change what I feel for you. However, I understand if you feel nothing back.” Casta said. “No… I love you as well, Casta.” Shadow replied. “Just… promise me that once you find someone else you love, someone alive, you will choose them over me and

won’t look back.” “I promise, but until then I will stay with you,” Casta said and pulled Shadow into a kiss. Her lips were as cold as the snowflakes falling outside, but Casta still didn’t pull away. Living in a haunted house wasn’t that bad after all.

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